

A comprehensive list of these cities with over 20,000 people, broken down by their primary location relative to downtown Chicago, includes:

West & Far West Suburbs

- Aurora: ~181,000 residents
- Naperville: ~153,000 residents
- Joliet: ~152,000 residents
- Elgin: ~115,000 residents
- Bolingbrook: ~75,000 residents
- Schaumburg: ~76,000 residents
- Downers Grove: ~50,000 residents
- Elmhurst: ~46,000 residents
- Carol Stream: ~39,000 residents
- Geneva: ~22,000 residents [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [5](#)]

North & Northwest Suburbs

- Waukegan: ~89,000 residents
- Arlington Heights: ~76,000 residents
- Palatine: ~68,000 residents
- Skokie: ~65,000 residents
- Des Plaines: ~61,000 residents
- Mount Prospect: ~54,000 residents
- Crystal Lake: ~40,000+ residents
- Elk Grove Village: ~32,000 residents
- Gurnee: ~31,000 residents
- North Chicago: ~31,000 residents
- Highland Park: ~30,000 residents
- Algonquin: ~30,000 residents [[1](#), [3](#), [4](#)]

South & Southwest Suburbs

- Cicero: ~84,000 residents
- Orland Park: ~59,000 residents
- Tinley Park: ~57,000 residents
- Oak Lawn: ~57,000 residents
- Berwyn: ~54,000 residents

- Maywood: ~23,000 residents [[1](#), [2](#)]

Indiana Satellites (Chicagoland/Gary Metro Area)

- Hammond: ~78,000 residents
- Gary: ~69,000 residents
- Merrillville: ~36,000 residents
- Portage: ~37,000 residents
- Crown Point: ~34,000 residents
- Munster: ~23,000 residents [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)]

Wisconsin Satellites

- Kenosha: ~99,000 residents [[1](#)]